

Absolutely — **peculiar** is a strong Tier 1 polysemy target because your passage uses it here:

> “harsh words have a **peculiar** way of lingering longer than praise.”

Here **peculiar** means **strange or unusual in a noticeable way**. But the word also has an important older/formal meaning: **belonging especially or exclusively to a particular person, place, group, or thing**.

Word family: **peculiar / peculiarly / peculiarity**

Base adjective: peculiar

Adverb: peculiarly

Noun: peculiarity

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞)

Meaning in your passage: **peculiar = strange / unusual — 奇怪的；異常的；特別的**

Your sentence:

> “harsh words have a **peculiar** way of lingering longer than praise.”

Here **peculiar** means:

> **strange, unusual, and somewhat difficult to explain.**

繁體中文：

有點奇怪、反常或難以解釋的

Natural translation:

> “harsh words have a peculiar way of lingering longer than praise”

「尖刻的話往往有一種很**奇怪的特性**，會比讚美留在心裡更久。」

So here:

> **peculiar = 奇怪而又明顯不同尋常的**

1. **peculiar = strange / odd / unusual — 奇怪的；古怪的；異常的**

The exact source sense.

Practice 1 — Original

> “Harsh words have a **peculiar** way of lingering.”

「尖刻的話有一種很**奇怪的特性**，總會久久不散。」

Practice 2

> “There was a **peculiar** smell in the room.”

「房間裡有一股**奇怪的氣味**。」

Practice 3

> “He gave me a peculiar look.”

「他用一種很**古怪的眼神**看著我。」

peculiar = 明顯不同尋常、令人覺得奇怪或難以解釋的

2. **peculiar** = distinctive / characteristic in an unusual way — 特有的；獨特的

A closely related but more neutral sense.

Practice 4

> “The building has a **peculiar** shape.”

「這座建築有一個很**獨特的形狀**。」

Practice 5

> “She has a peculiar style of speaking.”

「她有一種很**獨特的說話方式**。」

peculiar = 有明顯與眾不同特徵的

Depending on context, this can sound:

* neutral

* mildly negative

* intriguing

3. **peculiar to + person/place/thing = 某人 / 某地 / 某物特有的**

A major formal sense.

Practice 6

> “This custom is **peculiar to** the region.”

「這個習俗是這個地區**特有的**。」

Practice 7

> “The problem is peculiar to small businesses.”

「這個問題是小型企業**特有的**。」

peculiar to X = 只屬於 X、特別出現在 X 身上的

This sense is more formal and less about “strange”.

4. **peculiar = belonging exclusively to someone/something — 專有的；特屬的**

An older/formal extension.

Practice 8

> “The tradition was peculiar to that community.”

「這項傳統是那個社群**特有的**。」

Practice 9

> “Certain risks are peculiar to the industry.”

「某些風險是這個行業**特有的**。」

peculiar = 特別屬於某個人、地方、群體或事物的

This overlaps with #3, so conceptually I would merge them.

5. **peculiarly = strangely / unusually — 奇怪地；異常地**

Practice 10

> “He behaved **peculiarly** during the meeting.”

「他在會議期間表現得很**奇怪**。」

Practice 11

> “The room was peculiarly quiet.”

「房間安靜得有點**異常**。」

peculiarly = 以奇怪、異常或不同尋常的方式

6. **peculiarly = especially / uniquely — 特別地；獨有地**

A formal adverbial use.

Practice 12

> “The issue is **peculiarly** relevant to young people.”

「這個議題對年輕人尤其**特別相關**。」

Practice 13

> “The problem affects this region peculiarly strongly.”

「這個問題對這個地區的影響**格外強烈**。」

peculiarly = 特別地、尤其地，常帶「某群體特別如此」的意思

This use is more formal and less common in everyday speech.

7. **peculiarity = strange/unusual feature — 怪異之處；特異之處**

The main noun meaning.

Practice 14

> “One **peculiarity** of the system is its lack of buttons.”

「這個系統其中一個**奇特之處**是沒有按鈕。」

Practice 15

> “Everyone noticed the peculiarity of his behaviour.”

「大家都注意到他行為上的**古怪之處**。」

peculiarity = 某人 / 某物顯得奇怪、異常或獨特的特徵

8. **peculiarity** = distinctive characteristic — 特有特徵；獨特性

A more neutral noun sense.

Practice 16

> “The dialect has several regional **peculiarities**.”

「這種方言有幾個地區性的**獨特特徵**。」

Practice 17

> “The design reflects the peculiarities of the local climate.”

「這個設計反映了當地氣候的**特殊性 / 特有特點**。」

peculiarity = 某地、某群體或某事物特有的特徵

Important distinction: **peculiar vs strange**

strange

= general word for unusual or unfamiliar.

peculiar

= often suggests:

* noticeably odd

* distinctive

* sometimes characteristic of one particular thing

> strange noise

> = 奇怪的聲音

> peculiar habit

> = 古怪 / 特有的習慣

****Peculiar**** often feels slightly more formal or marked.

Important distinction: ****peculiar vs odd****

****odd****

= strange, unusual, sometimes mildly humorous.

****peculiar****

= strange in a more distinctive or noticeable way.

> odd question

> = 古怪問題

> peculiar behaviour

> = 異常 / 古怪行為

They overlap strongly.

Important distinction: ****peculiar vs unusual****

****unusual****

= not common.

****peculiar****

= not only uncommon, but often noticeably strange or distinctive.

> unusual colour

> = 不常見的顏色

> peculiar colour

> = 很怪 / 很特別的顏色

So **peculiar** often carries stronger reaction.

Important distinction: **peculiar vs unique**

unique

= one of a kind / unlike any other.

peculiar

= strange or characteristic of a particular thing.

> unique design

> = 獨一無二的設計

> peculiar design

> = 很特別 / 古怪的設計

Not interchangeable.

Important distinction: **peculiar vs particular**

These are easy to confuse.

particular

= specific / certain.

peculiar

= strange, distinctive, or specific to something.

> a particular student

> = 某一位學生

> a peculiar student

> = 一個很古怪的學生

Completely different meaning.

Important distinction: **peculiar to** vs **specific to**

peculiar to

= 特有於某個人 / 地方 / 群體

specific to

= specifically limited to that thing, more neutral/technical

> “This feature is peculiar to the region.”

= 這個特徵是該地區特有的。

> “This symptom is specific to the disease.”

= 這個症狀是該疾病特有的。

Peculiar to may sound more literary/formal.

Important distinction: **peculiar** = strange vs **peculiar to** = 特有

This is the strongest polysemy contrast.

Strange:

> “That is a peculiar smell.”

= 那股氣味很奇怪。

Characteristic/exclusive:

> “That custom is peculiar to the village.”

= 那個習俗是該村特有的。

Same adjective, different interpretation.

Important distinction: **peculiar in your passage**

Your sentence:

> “harsh words have a peculiar way of lingering longer than praise.”

Here **peculiar** does **not** mean:

> 「這種方式只屬於 harsh words」

It means:

> **there is something strangely noticeable about how negative comments stay in memory longer than praise**

Natural Chinese:

- * 奇怪地
- * 很奇妙 / 很反常地
- * 有一種奇怪的特性

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory includes:

- * **peculiar — strange** = 奇怪 / 古怪 / 異常的
- * **peculiar — distinctive** = 獨特 / 與眾不同的
- * **peculiar to** = 某人 / 某地 / 某物特有的
- * **peculiarly — strangely** = 奇怪 / 異常地
- * **peculiarly — especially** = 特別 / 格外地
- * **peculiarity — strange feature** = 怪異之處 / 奇特之處
- * **peculiarity — distinctive feature** = 特有特徵 / 特殊性

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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peculiar — strange	明顯不同尋常、令人覺得奇怪或難以解釋的
peculiar — distinctive	具有明顯與眾不同特徵的
peculiar to X	只屬於 / 特別出現在某人、地方、群體或事物中的
peculiarly — strange	以奇怪、異常或不同尋常的方式
peculiarly — especially	特別 / 格外地
peculiarity — strange feature	某人 / 某物顯得奇怪或異常的特徵
peculiarity — distinctive feature	某群體 / 地方 / 事物特有的特徵

For your original sentence

> “Even so, harsh words have a **peculiar** way of lingering longer than praise.”

The exact meaning is:

peculiar = 負面說話往往會比讚美更長久留在心裡，這種現象令人覺得有點奇怪、反常又難以解釋。

Natural translation:

> **「即使如此，尖刻的話卻往往有一種很奇怪的特性，會比讚美在心裡停留得更久。」**

The highest-value contrasts are:

- > **peculiar smell** → 奇怪的氣味
- > **peculiar behaviour** → 古怪的行為
- > **peculiar style** → 獨特的風格
- > **peculiar to this region** → 這個地區特有的
- > **peculiarly quiet** → 安靜得異常
- > **peculiarity** → 奇特之處 / 特有特徵
- > **peculiar vs particular** → 奇怪 / 特有的 vs 某個特定的